

Don’t trust the voice. Trust the call-back.

5 steps to stop fake bosses, fake vendors, and fake urgent requests.

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01 Set the triggers

02 Call back on a known number

03 Add a second approver

04 Give key people a safe word

05 Make pausing safe

SWIPE →

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

WHAT THE FBI REPORTED

$3.05B

lost to business email compromise in 2025, across 24,768 complaints.

FBI IC3 2025 Annual Report. Businesses reported over $30 million of it in scams involving AI.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

It won’t sound fake. That’s the point.

The FBI says AI-generated voice and video can be hard to tell from the real thing. Your team can’t rely on spotting the tell.

> Who can approve a payment at your firm today?

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

01

Set the triggers

Pick the requests that always get a check: money, bank changes, codes, passwords, and client data.

> Try this: write the list in one sentence.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

VERIFY BEFORE YOU PAY

02

Call back on a known number

Hang up. Find the number in your own records, never in the message. Call and confirm.

> Try this: keep your known numbers in one shared file.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

03

Add a second approver

Over your limit, two people sign off and write down the time of the call.

> Try this: pick the limit today, even a rough one.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

04

Give key people a safe word

Agree on it in person. Never write it in email or chat.

> The FBI suggests a safe word for families. The idea works at work too.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

VERIFY BEFORE YOU PAY

05

Make pausing safe

Tell your team: anyone can pause any request, and nobody gets in trouble for it.

> Try this: pin the message in team chat.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

Your verify rule:

- [ ] Triggers listed
- [ ] Call-back on known numbers
- [ ] Second approver
- [ ] Safe word set
- [ ] Pausing is safe

FREE · CHECKLIST

Get the full Verify Before You Pay free at

pragentic.ai/verify-before-you-pay

Link in the first comment. Follow Pragentic.AI for weekly AI briefs.

Save this for your next team meeting.